[INCH-POUND]
A-A-230A
July 15, 1992
SUPERSEDING
A-A-230
January 9, 1980

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

MAT, BATH (Disposable)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This commercial item description covers disposable paper bath mats.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The documents referenced in this commercial item description shall be the issues in effect on the date of issuance of the invitation for bids or request for proposals unless otherwise specified. These documents form a part of this commercial item description to the extent specified. In the event of a conflict between this commercial item description and a document referenced herein, this commercial item description shall take precedence.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions clarifications, etc... and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: General Services Administration, Engineering Group (7FXEE), 819 Taylor St, Fort Worth, TX 76102.

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

FSC 7210

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Federal Standard:

FED-STD-376 - Preferred Metric Units For General Use By The Federal Government.

Copies of Federal standards are available from the General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston, MA; New York, NY; Philadelphia, PA; Washington, DC; Atlanta, GA; Chicago, IL; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth, TX; Denver, CO; San Francisco, CA; Los Angeles, CA; and Seattle, WA, and the GSA Specifications Unit (3FBP-W), 7th and D Streets S.W., Washington, DC 20407.

Military Standard:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

Copies of military standards may be obtained from Standardization Documents Order Desk, Bldg. 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

ASTM Standard:

E 29 - Standard Practice For Using Digits In Test Data To Determine Conformance With Specifications.

Application for copies of ASTM standards should be addressed to ASTM, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

TAPPI Standards:

T402 - Standard Conditioning and Testing Atmospheres for Paper, Board, Pulp Handsheets, and Related Products.
T403 - Bursting Strength of Paper.
T410 - Grammage of Paper and Paperboard
T456 - Wet Tensile Breaking Strength of Paper and Paperboard.

Application for copies of TAPPI standards should be addressed to TAPPI, 15 Technology Parkway South, P.O Box 105113, Norcross, GA 30092.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

3.1 Material and dimensions. The bath mats shall be made from highly absorbent 100 percent bleached chemical pulp with characteristics as shown in table I. The mat shall be embossed and shall be 14 inches +/- 1/2 inch in width and 20-1/2 inches +/- 1/2 inch in length. All edges shall be straight cut. The bath mat shall be bleached white in color. All dimensions are absolute as defined in ASTM E 29.

TABLE I - Characteristics

Characteristic	Requirement	TAPPI Test Method
Basis weight/3000 sq. ft.	75 lbs. +/- 5 lbs.	T410
Bursting strength, embossed	40 lbs. min.	T403
Wet tensile strength	10 lbs. min.	T456

Note: The TAPPI test methods indicated have been found acceptable to determine if the bath mats meet the stated requirements. The mats shall be conditioned and tested in accordance with TAPPI T402.

3.2 Workmanship. The finished product shall be clean and free from dirt and foreign matter. The bath mat shall be free from holes, wrinkles, ragged edges, fragments, paper dust, tears, dirt, or other defects.

3.3 Regulatory requirements. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable.

3.4 Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch pound units, provided they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of FED-STD-376, and all other requirements of this commercial item description are met.

3.5 Commercial item. The use of the term "commercial item description" in this document does not imply that any item or items offered are not required to conform with all requirements specified herein.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, contractors may use their own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling. The levels of inspection and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.3 Lot formation. All bath mats from the same manufacturer offered for delivery at one time shall be considered a lot for purposes of inspection and testing.

4.4 Sampling criteria for each individual TAPPI test. The lot shall be expressed in units of bath mats. All testing shall be conditioned and tested in accordance with T 402. Sample shall be taken separately for each TAPPI test required as listed above in paragraph 3.1, Table 1. An adequate number of consecutive bath mats will be used to insure sufficient area to complete all referenced TAPPI test requirements. All samples shall be selected in accordance with Inspection Level S-2, no AQL. Any **test unit average** (within a sample) which does not meet specified requirements constitutes a rejection. The lot shall be rejected whenever the sample unit average results do not meet the requirements cited for each characteristic.

4.5 Sampling for visual and dimensional examination. A random sample of bath mats shall be selected from each lot in accordance with inspection level S-4, AQL 4.0, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units. The sample bath mats shall be visually and dimensionally examined to verify compliance with table II and the remainder of this commercial item description. The sample unit shall be one bath mat. No more than two bath mats shall be drawn from any one unit container. The lot size shall be expressed in units of bath mats.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. Classification of defects

Examine	Defect
Construction and Workmanship	Not uniform (material) Material feels rough or abrasive Not clean; contains dirt, dust or foreign matter Distortions, holes, tears, wrinkles, ragged edges Two or more fused together. Edges not as specified Dimensions not as specified Color not as specified

4.6 Examination for preparation for delivery. A random sample of shipping containers shall be selected from each lot for examination of the unit, intermediate and shipping containers (as applicable) for conformance with the preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking required in the contract or order. Samples shall be selected in accordance with inspection level S-2, AQL 6.5, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units. The sample unit shall be one shipping container.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging, packing, and marking. The packaging, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents (if applicable).

a. Title, number and date of this commercial item description.
b. The packaging, packing, and marking desired.

6.2 National Stock Number (NSN). The following NSN references this commercial item description: NSN 7210-00-177-4992.

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

GSA-FSS

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DOD has determined that no military activity has an official interest in this commercial item description.

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.